



YOGTANTRAGAMA
ISSN NO: 2454-888X



Sep- Oct 2016

From the Editor in Chief's desk:

By Swami Paranand Tirth

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" The river of awareness flows between the banks of vice and virtue. Laden with conscience and wisdom it flows towards virtuous side otherwise it flows towards the vicious side "- says Vyasa the most authentic commentator on yoga aphorisms of Patanjali.

Introvert seers of the past with their refined and restrained intellect had an intuitive insight into the subtle psycho cognitive phenomena which can be experienced only

subjectively . The entire methodology of mystic science is not about imparting the theoretical details but about inducing and sharing the subjective experience . The method devised by the enlightened seers has been propagated through an uninterrupted and authentic lineage so it remains unalloyed by meddler's intermingling of what is not supposed to be there .

There are myriad construes of the mind matter said Vyasa but all of them can converge into five which are further classified as two groups i.e. Vicious and virtuous .The yogic world view converges into a penta-dimensional phenomena which has been devised to facilitate the manipulation of these construes of the mind matter (called वृत्तिः) in Sanskrit . In a divergent pursuit motivated by ones lower nature all neural cerebral functioning is heading towards direct perception and the reciprocation of responses generated by such

stimuli . Transcending this conventional trend of divergent pursuit is a great feat.

One canon on eastern metaphysics says God the creator made the senses extrovert so they perceive only the objective phenomena and not the Self .A rare man of great self-restraint ,desirous of immortality withdrew his senses and realised his essential nature . The procedure that comes through the lineage of such Seers has made this otherwise Herculean task easy and well defined . An aspirant has to go subjectively about yoga right since the beginning -just me and my mind .I categorise my thought constructs in five ways . Direct perception ,inference ,and revelations . These three collectively called (प्रमाणम्) are the only input of objectivity into the awareness . Rest of the constructs are subjective and convergent . Imagery or Distraction is of two types when it is verbal devoid of any substantial relevance it is called विकल्पः . The thought construct generated by false or aberrant visual perception is called विपर्ययः .These are drift and distractions which impede both direction perception as well as memory . The sutras say that when there is a complete stoppage of these five mind construes the aspirant is seated in his essential nature otherwise he is in unison with these thought constructs and is perpetually deviated from his essential nature . One must have been seated in his essential nature at least once to understand the phenomena distinctly . This is possible only through the munificence of a preceptor without which individual effort is of no avail .

This seating and identifying with the universal self is initiation of दीक्षा, a great passage rite in the life of a spiritual aspirant. In fact all exoteric rites and rituals must culminate into into this esoteric initiation in order to fructify . The thought

construct depending on the experience of total absence is defined as sleep निद्रा where as memory or स्मृति is the retention and prevention of the erasing of the experience of an object.

All these must be stopped in order to be seated in one's essential nature but to orientate and manipulate these for attaining perfection in a material sense is also accepted in the lore of Tantras and Agamas . Minimising drift distraction and all other types of perceptions except the agama or an authentic dictum and memory can bring in miraculous improvement in the area of academic and educational ventures . Cutting down on the input of the stimuli which generate impeding thought constructs and facilitating the flow of conducive streamline of awareness can be a great pragmatic and utilitarian implementation of "yoga ". With each construes of the mind matter which we have mentioned above ,there can be a great innovative progress in the area of creativity, literature , visual art, aesthetics, science, technology, entrepreneurship diplomacy ,administration so on and so forth . There must be more and more genuine yogis who can help others in transcending their cognitive conditioning and manipulating subjectively their fluctuations of the mind matter which needless to say directly effects the humanity in the gross phenomena and thus the stage of world affairs .

This along with many other specialties of the oriental metaphysical tradition go hand in hand with some recent trends in multidisciplinary faculties of cognitive science .

Swami Paranand Tirth
Founder President and CEO
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Editorial

“If you choose to be in bliss, you will be in suffering, because to be in bliss means to be choiceless” Osho

Choicelessness, a concept usually associated with total helplessness and pitiable condition is seen as mandatory condition for attaining true bliss. The idea sounds completely bizarre at first but on deeper contemplation and introspection it starts making sense and eventually its true import is grasped by an aspirant. Since choosing is about eliminating, the person who makes conscious choices can never achieve completeness and neither understand the totality of existence.

What we intend to eliminate and wish away is also the part of that ultimate totality and the more we try to keep it at bay the more aggressively it comes back to haunt us. The more we cling to things the more suffering we invite for our selves. We will be always in the fear of losing the object of desire, tangible or intangible. Life is always in state of flux and nothing remains constant, not even what we choose. If we choose day, night will follow. If we choose light, dark will follow and if we choose life, death will follow and if we don't choose we will go with the flow and become one with the stream of universal consciousness.

As we at YTA continue our journey under the divine guidance of our Guru Swami Paranand Tirthji the doors keep opening one by one. Nothing but the grace

will determine whether we will shut our eyes or get a glimpse to the other side or enter the mysterious unknown realm and delve. With these ponderings we present this 6th issue of YTA newsletter. As usual we begin with an enlightening editorial by Swami Paranand Tirth ji discussing the idea of ‘self awareness’ and how intellectual and intuitive seers of past had insight into the subtle psycho cognitive phenomena which can be experienced only subjectively and has been propagated through an uninterrupted and authentic lineage.

Following this we have Swamiji's article on development of intuitive insight in the nature of Purusa which can liberate an individual from limited existence and seat him/her in their ‘essential nature’. The aspect of choicelessness as an important factor for realizing the essential nature, which sets the tone of this editorial has also been discussed here citing important examples.

‘Prana- Astrology’ in Kalachakra Tantra’ is the theme which Niraj Kumar explores in his thoroughly researched article. The Kalachakra Tantra and its Prana-astrology teaches us to perceive things holistically and to see things without the outer coverings. Moreover, only through the junction, one can aspire to attain the state of enlightenment. Like all Tantras Kalachakra Tantra too aims at drawing a parallel between the microcosm and macrocosm.

Next we have a thought provoking introduction to the concepts of Indian aesthetics by a stalwart of

literary, philosophical and cultural studies, Dr S.S Toshkhani. Starting from Bharata's Natyashastra and Rasa-Sutra it goes on to explore various commentaries on Rasa-Sutra by Sri Shankuka, Bhatta Kallata, Bhatta Tauta and so on. The article will be concluded in our next issue.

Following this we have meticulously described and well illustrated travelogue by Dr G.L Kaw about the famous Muktinath Yatra. Muktinath is an extremely holy shrine about 400 kms from Kathmandu on the northern part of Nepal-Tibet border. The write-up succinctly describes author's journey from Nepalganj –Kathmandu-Pokhara – Jomsom and finally to Muktinath and the sites they visited en-route.

The echo of spiritual longing as well as longing for ones land can be seen in the poems by Rashneek Kher. While the first one talks about the coalescing of human with divine the second one portrays the void created by exile in a sensitive human heart.

To conclude the issue we have an insightful book review on G.V Tagare's book 'The Pratyabhijna Philosophy' by Dr Advaitvadini Kaul. The overall tone of the book and chapter wise thorough discussion gives a clear glimpse into both content and intent of the book.

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WISDOM FROM SHIVA'S RATTLE DRUM- 6**The Rhythm and the beat of nature****Swami Paranand Tirth**

सत्त्वं रजस्तम इति गुणानां त्रितयं पुरा
समाश्रित्य महादेवः शब्दं क्रीडति प्रभुः

1 The Celestial Sporting

There is an interesting reflection on the Prakriti and Purusa relationship in the holy books. Purusa it suggests, conceptualised Prakriti in a small negligible portion within his infinite domain . In some recent tantrik canons Purusa and Prakriti depicted as Shiv and Shakti are described as in perpetual unison and semiotically defined as a drawing that looks like an elephant from one end and a bull from another side.

कस्मिंश्चिदलेख्य विशेषे गजवृषभयोरकृतिवत्
एकस्मिन् वस्तुनिशिवशक्तिविभागकल्पनांकुर्मः
(महार्थमंजरी)

From a divergent perspective the Shakti aspect predominates whereas Shiva aspect dominates from a convergent perspective . One might as well replace Prakriti or the primordial causation as the three fold nature which, as per the next aphorism is latent . Only the transcendental principle can sport with the universal manifestation and not something conditioned in it . The sport being creation sustenance and dissolution of the universal phenomena . The dawning of metaphysical wisdom through the aphorisms of Maheshwara predates the compilation of the Samkhya aphorisms albeit this doctrine traces its root in the Vedic dictum.

A great goat of red white and dark hue procreates many offsprings . A play on the word अजा a goat or an unborn entity can be seen here . The three letters are the three attributes of the Samkhya philosophy viz Raj Tama and Shukla. Offsprings are defined as the twenty four elements listed in the Samkhya ontology. The Meaning of karika or this aphorism indicates that this aphorism itself predates the manifestation or let us say the aftermath of the

disturbance of the homogeneity of the three gunas . Three gunas arise from the three beats of the drum . Esoterically this aims at the transcendental origin of the three gunas which in this case is not even Lord Shiva but his rattle drum .

Word has been conceptualised as eternal and to vindicate this there are many viewpoints about its origin .The present one relates this manifestation to pashyanti mode of manifestation of vak which according to another tantric canon pertains to Ishwara the subtle most being 'the absolute'. The grosser One I.e. Madhyama corresponds to mahat or the collective intelligence . This also supports the argument of the beginning lessness and all pervasiveness of the word .

There are two versions of Sankhya school of thought as we have already mentioned while elaborating on the preceding aphorism . Independently it may not be feasible since it must refute all other five schools of thought for its raison de etre . As an alternative doctrine to conduce to monism till the hurdles of merits and demerits subside and the knowledge of the self dawns ,Samkhya is a great doctrine in as much as it leads to the ultimate objective successively though.

3 The Dental, palatial and cranial syllables as the three gunas.

(The theory of the divine origin of word and the neuroscientific effect of the pronunciation of sanskrit syllables.)

Right from the primordial resonance of the eternal word which manifests as the empirical soul and attains grosser modes as spiritual air and alphabet (63 sixty three in number) mixed with the fire of consciousness, cosmic intelligence and individual reason the वाक् or speech becomes audible expression .

A specific region has been attributed to each syllable and each one of the eight group of letters to which it belongs . There are further divisions according to the amount of stress used for their pronunciation . This accounts for the mystic power generated by systematic pronunciation or mental recollection of a specific arrangement of these letters or मातृका including their various combinations with nasals and aspirata accents.

देवस्यैष स्वभावोयम् आप्तकामस्य का स्पृहा

Gaudpadacharya, the illustrious exponent of Ajatvada says this divergence of consciousness is the nature of the Lord himself because how can a complete being aspire for something? This sporting is the lord's nature like a rich man who likes to display his grandeur . This sporting is through his three gunas . He identifies himself as conditioned in the three gunas which in their state of perfect homogeneity are contained within the expanse of infinite domain . By exercising his will he causes a divergent creative upsurge and disturbs their equilibrium. Excess Rajas accounts for creation, superfluous satva is the agency of sustenance and tamas leads to dissolution .

Nandikeshwar says that this phenomena is encrypted in the eighth beat of his rattle drum which can be imagined as three delicate soft brushing of the two strings against the two sides of his celestial chod or rattle drum . Generating the primordial three dental ,palatial and cerebral syllables ,these three ऊष्माण the heat generating sounds as their Sanskrit nomenclature suggests -are the three gunas and the Lord plays the game of creation sustenance and dissolution through them . This sporting is not a compulsion but the nature of the Lord. Coincidentally nature is also understood as Prakriti which accounts for the universal phenomena .Purusa remains a non doer or just the witnessing uninvolved principle.

नवद्वारपुरेदेही नैवकुर्वन्नकारयन्

In this township called the body with nine gates the owner or Dehi neither does anything nor motivates other entities for any action . These three gunas are binding deluding and compulsive . All activities physical or cognitive can be attributed to these . The cycle of nescience , desire and action which are the produces of tamas , Rajas and satva causes the reciprocation of innate beginning less delusion which accounts for all worldly endeavors . The purusa remains concealed within the haze of three gunas and their produces but if somehow I.e. through any spiritual knack or the redeeming power of the preceptor who is yet another ,anime station of the Purusa or Parampurusa one can transcend this compulsive delusion and attain unison with purusa

तत् परंपुरुषख्यातेर्गुणवैतृष्यम् (Yogasutra of Patanjali)

An intuitive insight into the nature of the Purusa leads to the termination of the reciprocation of three gunas . While involved in the three gunas and their produces it is not possible for an aspirant to transcend them .

In Gita the Lord says that my delusive power is impossible to cross but those who surrender to me can go beyond maya since I am beyond maya and her influence . Knowledge of the Param purusa of the sankhya school of thought ,dawns upon an aspirant after an unswerving devotion and commitment of dispassion . This is a bilateral phenomenon one attains absolute dispassion towards maya and her produces as the knowledge of the purusa dawns and the knowledge dawns only after one has attained a considerable degree of dispassion . This is called the maxim of a well digger कूपनिखानकन्यायः . A well digger is all soiled as he digs the well but as soon the digging is complete he can wash away his dirt in the clear water of the well . An aspirant still soiled and alloyed by maya and her produces upon attaining an intuitive perception of the purusa is cleansed instantaneously since these do not taint the purusa . Like wise those who have attained unison with the purusa are also not alloyed .

The Vedic purusa which predates both samkhya and yoga concept of purusa is essentially a singular entity whose knowledge leads an identification with him which is in fact not different from the kaivalyam or isolation of the yoga school or Nirvanam transcendence of all miseries of the samkhya .

Sporting of the Lord is innate since being a substratum of the delusive power and its produces he is not deluded by it ,like a conjurer who is not deluded by his own feats of hat trick . Real sporting can happen only after having ascertained the ephemeral or virtual nature of the universal phenomena , a knower of Brahman as the blissful absolute dreads nothing and fears no one- says the Upanishad . The Lord is not only enlightened but enlightenment itself hence he sports casually with his nature and Her produces . He has been signified as the great Lord or Mahadev by Nandikeshwar the author of metaphysical import of the fourteen aphorisms from the beats owing to his divine grandeur and splendor he uses these three gunas as his chips,or dice or other means of sporting .

Any aspirant or empirical soul who wants to transcend these gunas and their produces must inculcate a very special vision of choicelessness. All choice making are within the domain of these three gunas .One must transcend simultaneously all these three gunas and identify with his guna less essential nature .

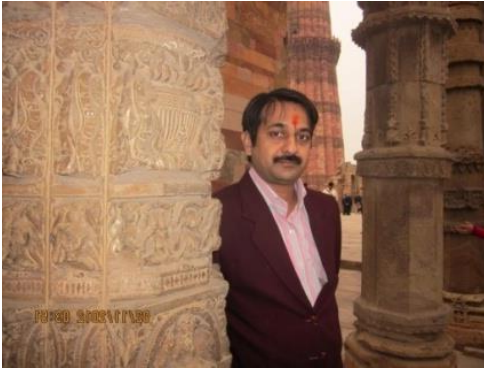
What are the characteristics of a man who has transcended these three gunas asks Arjuna in the Gita ,how can we spot him by his conduct . He makes no choice says the Lord both convergent light and divergent darkness, both are merely delusion .An enlightened being has no bent for withdrawal or divergence .He neither refrains from action and seeks absorption nor does he despise action and dynamic out flux of awareness . Through his intuitive insight he knows that both are within the domain of nescience .So ultimately he sits inertly or to be more exact stays apparently nonchalant without being swerved by the frequency of the three gunas . He maintains that this is only a reciprocation of the gunas and not his transcendental essential nature . This choiceless awareness is the knack of transcending these gunas and identifying with ones essential nature .

मत्वेति हेलया किंचित् मा गृहाण विमुंच मा

Having ascertained thus O Janak instructs his preceptor Astavakra "don't adhere to anything nor let go of anything ".Shun all attachment and detachment concomitantly” . Making choice will hurl your awareness back into the abyss of relative existence

(To be continued)

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PRANA- ASTROLOGY IN THE KALACAKRA TANTRA

Niraj Kumar

Kalacakra Tantra is the culmination of thousand years of refinement of Indian tradition of knowledge in both dimensions- inner engineering and outer phenomena. Dehmadye Samastam (देहमध्ये समस्तं) or everything is contained within the Body - is the root essence of the text. The body itself is the universal text and the universal knowledge, on the other hand, is visualized as a body- the Vajra-Deha.

Time (Kala- काल) governs the individual body as well as the cosmic body. Time is the universal monarch. To understand temporality, one ought to understand the structure of phenomena both within body and outside body and the correlation between the two dimensions. The template within and without is same and it is the difference between mere scaling. Individual bodies- may be of microscopic bodies (अणु तनुज), human beings (नृप), spirits (भूत), divine beings (देव), demons (असुर), goddesses (शक्ति) - are all mere aspect of time. All these individual bodies are mere embodiment of processes of 21600 inhalation and exhalations.

While for human beings, 21600 inhalation and exhalation of breath correspond to one solar day and night, for the spirits and other kind of beings the length of 21600 breaths correspond to different measures of time. For the microscopic bodies, one subtle breath is equal to 21600 human breaths, and 21600 such subtle breaths constitute a solar day. A dhru is 30 times a human breath. A human breath equals 4 seconds. 21600 dhru constitutes the solar day for the ghosts and the spirits. Nadi is 360 human

breaths. It is one breath of the divine beings. 21600 such nadis constitutes the solar day for the devas. Similarly, a dina(दिन/ solar day) is 21600 human breaths long. It is a single breath for a demon. 21600 such breaths constitute the solar day for the demon. A yuga is 21600 years of a human being. It is the one breath of the superior Shaktis. 21600 such breaths constitute a solar day for the superior shaktis.

The pair of inhalation/exhalation constitutes the basis of flow of time. At the ultimate level, the inhalation/exhalation is the pralaya- Srishti sequence of the phenomenal universe. This is the ultimate Kalacakra- the cycle of time where every appearance is bound to dissolve and thence the next cycle emanates. The Kalacakra, many opine, is this connection between time and astronomy with breath.

The seed of the next cycle is carried by the winds that hold the potency of the five elements- earth, water, fire, wind and space. The Kalacakra Tantra adds the sixth category of gnosis (jnana) as inherent in the flow of time.

The outer universe (Lokadhatu/लोकधातु) has ceaseless movement of the planets and the constellations in the gola(गोला). The gola has the nature of wind that makes the celestial body move constantly. The wind of gola is same as that of the wind of vital energies within individual body. Thus, a continuum between individual and cosmos is assumed through the movement of the winds.

Now the Kalacakra Tantra like other Tantras establish sound as mere modulation of breath. Thus, breath is also measured in terms of sound. One breath is equal to the time taken in uttering 10 long syllables. Since the process of inhalation/exhalation, dissolution/manifestation is ubiquitous, the sound pervades the universe. Mantras are then seen as modulation of breathing pattern through which winds can be manipulated for the well-being of individual bodies and through correlation transferring the influence over the cosmic bodies.

The movement of celestial objects as well as the prana(vital energy) through the nadis(the subtle extra-anatomical channels) takes place across the twelve zodiacs. There is unique fusion of the movement of prana at the navel chakra through the zodiacs and the movement of the planets through the

outer zodiac. Twelve zodiacs are linked to the twelve chains of causality in the Mahayana Theory of Pratītyasamutpāda (Dependent Origination). These twelve links (nidanas/causes) are as follow:

(i)ignorance (**avidya**) ;(ii) Thought- impressions about reality (**samskara**); (3) knowledge (**viijnana**), (iv) name and form(**nama-rupa**), (v) the six domains (**shadayatana**)—i.e., the five senses and their objects—and the mind as the coordinating organ of sense impressions; (vi) contact (**sparsha**) ; (vii) sensation (**vedana**) (viii) thirst (**trishna**) ; (ix) grasping (**upadana**); (x) the process of becoming (**bhava**), (xi) birth (**jati**) of the individual and hence to (xii) old age and death (**jara-marana**).



The twelve causes can be further categorized as cause-effect relationship in flow of time. While avidya, samskara are the past cause which causes the present effect of viijnana, nama-rupa, sada-ayatana, sparsha and vedana; the present causes of trishna. Upadan and bhava causes the future effect of jati and jara-maran.

The transition of these twelve causes (samkraman) becomes the mpment of realizing the akshar-sukham(अक्षर सुख). The Kalacakra Tantra thus engages with the point of transitions where two different qualias of time meet. This point of fusion is what generates the bliss (Ananda) and emptiness (shunyata). It is how the movement of planets from one zodiac to another gains utmost importance. Similarly, the movement of prana from one zodiac to another is to be intricately understood by a practitioner of the Kalacakra.

The twelve zodiacs are categorized in several ways to understand the movement from one house to another.

Since there are six basic elements in the Kalacakra system (earth, water, fire, wind, space and the gnosis); a pair of zodiac share the nature of one of the elements.

Element	Zodiac	Zodiac
Space	Capricorn	Sagittarius
Wind	Aquarius	Scorpio
Fire	Pisces	Libra
Water	Aries	Virgo
Earth	Taurus	Leo
Gnosis	Gemini	

The zodiacs are arranged further in the even and odd categories

Even Zodiac	Odd Zodiac
Right side of Body	Left Side of Body
Capricorn	Aquarius
Pisces	Aries
Taurus	Gemini
Cancer	Leo
Virgo	Libra
Scorpio	Cancer

The Fifth Chapter of the Kalacakra Tantra further elaborates upon the birth of the planets in different zodiacs. The Verse 190, Chapter V mentions that the Moon,, Venus and the Sun arose in Aries, Gemini and Cancer respectively. Mars arose in Leo, Jupiter in Virgo, Rahu in Libra, Mercury in Scorpio, Saturn in Sagittarius. The first to arise is the Sun born in the House of Cancer in line with the meridian of the central sector of the east. The solar day begins. The Sun moves anti-clockwise and then arrives at the Ashvin constellation in the east. The Moon is born in the Ashvin constellation, the first constellation of the first zodiac, Aries. At same time, the first lunar day begins. Now the sun and the Moon is in conjunction in the Ashvin constellation. On 15th day of the first lunar

month, the Moon passes through the Chitra constellation. Hence the first lunar month is names as the Chaitra. Till the next planet Mars was born, the sun and the Moon alternated their rule over day—one solar day succeeded by one lunar day and so on. When the Sun arose in the constellation of Magha in the House of Leo, it came in line with the meridian of the central eastern sector and the Mars was born in the east. The Mars became the ruler of the day. Now, the sun, Moon and the Mars ruled over successive days till the Mercury was born in the eastern sector. Similarly, the other planets were born in a fixed order in the east in particular constellation.

Arising Planet	Constellation and Zodiac
Sun	Cancer
Moon	Ashvin in Aries
Mars	Magh in Leo
Mercury	Anuradha in Sagittarius
Jupiter	Hasta in Virgo
Venus	Punarvasu in Gemini
Saturn	Mula in Sagittarius
Rahu(clockwise movement of the sun)	Chitra in Libra
Kalagni(clockwise movement of the sun)	Revati

When the sun passes through the House of Capricorn to the House of Gemini, it is said to be the Uttarayan. Similarly, the passing of the sun from the House of Cancer to Sagittarius is the Dakshinayan. In the Uttarayan phase, days are longer and nights shorter; while during the Dakshinayan, nights are longer and the days shorter. It is during the samkranti(transition) that the Sun is stated to take rest(Vishram) which generates the rasa(jouissance of relaxation). These stars , planets and constellations, are propelled by the winds of the Gola(Gola Vayu) as mentioned earlier. The Gola vayu moves around the Meru, the axis of the Lokadhatu in clockwise direction.

The planets also govern the elements carried by the prana- vayu inside the individual bodies. Ketu preside

over the earth element on the left side of the body while Saturn governs the earth element on the right side of the body and so on. The passing of the major elements through the odd zodiac houses correlate with the passing of the corresponding elements through the left nostrils. Similarly, the passing of the five major elements through the even zodiac Houses correlate with the passing of the corresponding elements through the right nostril of the body. Like the anuloma-pratiloma paradigm, the sequence of passing over of the major elements are inverted through opposite nostrils. Thus, if the sequence of the passing of elements through the left nostril is from space-wind-fire-water-earth in the uneven zodiac Houses, the sequence of passing of elements in the even zodiac Houses through the right nostril will be earth-water-fire-wind-space elements. Thus, the passing of the elements in the cosmos and the individual follow the same sequence.

Element	Ruling Planet	Ruling Planet
	Left Side	Right side
Akash	Rahu	Kalagni
Vayu	Moon	Sun
Agni	Mercury	Mars
Toya	Venus	Jupiter
Prithvi	Ketu	Saturn

The planets presiding over the five elements passing through left nostril are considered to be auspicious, while the planets governing the passing over of elements on the right side are considered inauspicious.

The Moon and the Sun play the pivotal role in the internal circulation of the prana-vayu. When the Moon transits through the uneven zodiacs in the north for six months, the elements of shukra(white essence) circulates in the left channel of individual body for six months. Similarly, when the Sun transits through the even zodiac Houses in the south, the elements of the raja (रज/red bindu) circulates through the right channels of individual body for the six months.

The correspondence with the movement of the sun and the moon through the zodiac houses is established with the movements of the five elements (major

mandala) through the internal zodiac in the navel chakra. In one zodiac, the prana vayu flows for 30 days. Since there are five major mandala of wind(of the dominant nature of 5 elements respectively) , each element takes six days to pass through a single petal of the zodiacal house. The path of elements and the planets when in convergence while transiting through the outer and the inner zodiac, the person is healthy and happy. When the paths diverge, the individual bodies suffer.

Since there are 12 Houses arising each solar day, a different Zodiac House arises every two hours on the eastern horizon. The same process occurs at the navel chakra where the cycle of internal zodiac operates. The Kalacakra Tantra describes the identification of the wind with the governing major element mandala. The wind that travels 16 angula(finger-breath) outside nostril is permeated by the space mandala. It also travels till the navel. The wind with vayu mandala travels at a distance of 15 angul from the nostril, that of agni mandala at a distance of 14 angula, toya mandala at a distance of 13 angula and prithvi mandala at a distance of 12 angula. These travel inside the body to a distance of 1 angula, 2 anguls, 3 angul and 4 angula below the navel, respectively. In addition, the sixth element, the jnana (gnosis) element presides over the sixth mandala. It is the jnana mandala which always enters the central channel during the cross-over after flow of five mandala of wind. It travels same distance on the inward as well as the outward side as the particular wind preceding the jnana-mandala wind.

How does prana-astrology operate at the navel chakra?

The Kalacakra Tantra mentions that there are three major channels passing through the body. The middle channel is the Avadhuti(~ Sushumna of Hindu tantras) flanked by the Rasna(right channel) and the Lalna(left channel). The uneven zodiacs are stacked on the left side and the even zodiacs on the right side. Each zodiac House has five sub-sections, each corresponding with a minor wind mandala. Thus, in 12 zodiac Houses there are a total of 60 wind- mandalas flowing each day. Since there are 64 nadis(channels) at the navel chakra with 4 empty channels, the 60 remaining channels each carry one particular wind-mandala each day.

At the time of birth, 56¼ wind flows through the central channel. The breath flows through both nostrils equally. It then enters the House of Aries. The governing major element is space-element since it is an uneven sign. Now the wind passes through five sub-section (petals) in the House of Aries with the following sequence of major element-minor element: space-space, space-wind, space-fire, space- water, space-earth. After 1800- 56¼ breaths, the wind movement changes from left to the right. Before that 56¼ breath again flows into the central channel when the breath flows equally through both nostrils and palpable to a sensible observer. Now the major mandala in the Taurus will be the earth element. Again there are five petals within the House of Taurus and each will carry a minor mandala in the following sequence: earth-earth, earth-water, earth-fire, earth-wind, earth- space. After 1800- 56¼ breaths, the wind movement again changes. Now, 56¼ breaths flow into the central channel and thence wind moves in the House of Gemini. Now the major mandala will be Wind and the five minor mandala in each petal will be as follow: wind-wind, wind-fire, wind-water, wind-earth, wind- space. Again after 1800- 56¼ breaths, wind movement changes. 56¼ breaths flow into the central channel and the wind movement shifts to the even zodiac House of Cancer. The major wind mandala will be that of water mandala and the sequence of the five minor wind- mandala will be as follow: water-water, water- fire, water- wind, water-space, water- earth. This movement continues at the navel chakra till 12 Houses arise each day. Within a day, 21600 breaths flow including the 675 breaths flowing through the median channel each day during the samkranti. Next day the major wind mandala that will arise in the House of Aries will be wind-mandala and that in the House of Taurus will be that of water-mandala. Thus, on every 6th day, a new cycle will start. In this sequence, when the wind movement changes from the left (uneven zodiacal House) to the right (even zodiacal House), the minor mandala will always be in the earth-to-earth sequence. Similarly, whenever the wind changes movement from the right to left, the sequence of the minor mandala will be space –to-space. On the left, six major elements flow-sixth being the gnosis mandala while on the right, there are only five mandalas that rotate.

Now when prana flows in governance mode in the Earth-mandala in even zodiac sign, there is dissolution (Laya) of the Water-mandala. When the Prana flows in

the water mandala, there is dissolution of the Fire-mandala. The process repeats endlessly till the Space-mandala governs and the gnosis mandala dissolves. Then prana flows in the gnosis mandala and the dissolution takes place in the Earth mandala. This is the Samhara sequence. Similarly, there is Srishti sequence on the left side where the uneven zodiacs are stacked.

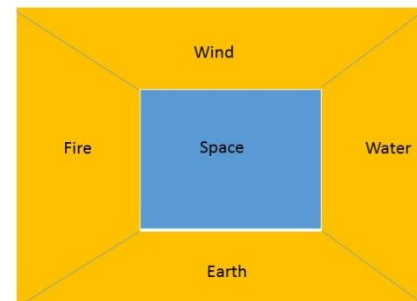
Central Support of the Eternal Movement



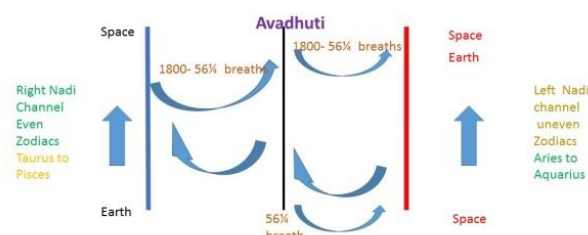
Internal Zodiac Cakra



Minor Mandalas of each Wind Mandala



Major wind Movements at Navel Cakra



The Kalacakra text thence exhorts the Yogi to keep breath in Vishuva(equal breath in both nostrils) for three years and three fortnights to attain the status of the Vajri. The Vajri is same as the Kalki outside. Now this formulation is clearly the culmination of the prana-astrology. Each day, an individual body experiences the 12 samkrantis(transits) of the zodiacs in the navel cakra. During the samkranti, the equal breaths(sama/ Vishuva-विषुव) flows through both the nostrils. There are 11 samkrantis in a day and $\frac{1}{2}$ samkranti both in the evening and in the morning making it 12. There are 4 Vishuvat samkranti in the four sandhya of the solar day viz. morning, afternoon, evening and midnight. Since the duration of the day

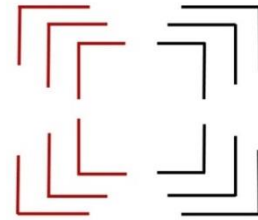
and night varies, the number of samkrantis in day and night also varies along with the solar movement outside. A total of 8 prahar and 4 sandhya gives the number 12 that correspond with 12 link of causation of the Pratītyasamutpāda. The daily passage of the sun and the Moon in the cosmic body is replicated as the daily passing of Prana in the right (rasna) and left(lalana) channel representing the sun and the Moon –principle within the individual body. There is thus a complete correspondence established between the outer cycle of zodiacs and the internal cycle of the zodiacs.

Each day 675 breaths flow equally. In one solar year (360 days), there will be 675 x 360 equal breaths of samkranti. In 100 years when all the 72000 nadis die away with average of two nadis being destroyed each day, there will be a total of 675 x 360 x 100 equal breaths. This when divided by the number of breaths each solar day provide the total number of 1125 days. 1125 days can be divided into 3 years (360 x 3 days) and 3 fortnights(15 x 3 days) (Verse II.106). Thus, the method of attaining the Vajri status gets discernible. In a normal human span of 100 years, one attains the status of Kalki/vajri having attained the equal breath of 3 years and 3 fortnight. The Tantra therefore defines Kalki as the state of death (Verse 2. 8) when all elements come together as one i.e. to make all as one caste like cementing with paste(*kalkh*)(Verse I.26 of the Root KCT). Wind which is the root of the movement and propels the cycle of existence, when controlled with vishuva phase become the liberator from the ceaseless cycle of karma.

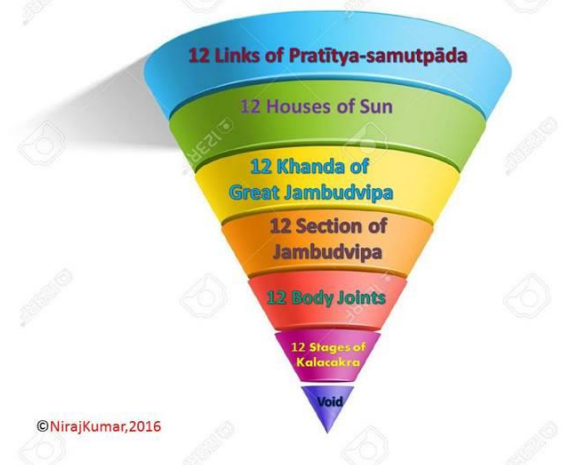
If a Yogi can breathe equally through both nostrils for three years and three fortnight, he need not await for full 100 years to attain the state of Kalki since he can develop the equanimity through Yogic practises within a short span of time and eliminate the effects of elements thereby the cycle of Karma itself.

It is this attainment of the equal breath and hence equanimity of mind during the passing through zodiac gate, which gets represented as the 12 gates of the Kalacakra mandala. The three layers of the Kaya (Body), Vak(speech) and Mind(citta) each with four gates on each side provides the opportunity to realize the Bliss and the Emptiness.

Twelve Gates of the Kalacakra Mandala
~ 12 Zodiacs



द्वादश खण्ड संक्रान्ति और फ्रेक्टल ब्रह्मण्ड



Kalacakra Tantra is precursor of Network Philosophy of the Internet Age. Kalacakra Tantra teaches us to build the bridges to cross over the ideational ridges. In the 12 doorways of the Mandala, each corresponds to the sections of 12-sectoral Wheel of Time. This corresponds with the 12- Divisions of the earth and the 12 –sections of the Jambu Dvipa. Within the body, there are 12 doorways in the KCT system- 6 chakras and 6 knots. It is the falling down of the white bindu (drops) which a Yogi/tantric of the path aspires. White and red drops falling and moving is a kind of Rangapatam(रंगपातं), a term evoked in the root text. There are 12 sections of joints (parva) inside

individual body which is also affected by the zodiac movement across the body.

The Kalacakra Tantra and its Prana-astrology teaches us to perceive things holistically and to see things without the outer coverings. Moreover, only through the junction, one can aspire to attain the state of enlightenment. This discourages the bigots of major religions from adhering stubbornly with their own version of Truth. The ultimate science of inner engineering that the Kalacakra Tantra teaches is sect-invariant and secular in its application. No doubt, the adherents to its principles are growing fast. The Tantras are meant to free the individuals from the bindings and to realize the whole within one's body by dissolving limitations. But, the mumbo-jumboization in the name of Tantra is leading to pernicious influence over genuine spiritual seekers.

**(Niraj Kumar is the student of Nalanada Tradition.
His forthcoming work is on *Nalanda Tradition*)**



KASHMIR'S CONTRIBUTION TO INDIAN AESTHETICS

Dr. S.S Toshkhani

It is really very exciting to think that this small paradisaal Valley nestled in the Himalays has produced a succession of brilliant thinkers who have formulated most of the fundamental concepts of Sanskrit poetics and have given us a whole body of aesthetic thought profound in conception and impressive in volume and value. One cannot but be overwhelmed by the fact that almost all the major schools of Indian aesthetics were founded by Kashmiri theoreticians -the Alankara School by Bhamaha, Riti School by Vamana, Vakrokti School by Kuntaka, Dhvani School by Anandavardhana and Auchitya School by Kshemendra. Though the concept of Rasa was evolved by Bharata, and perhaps by thinkers even before him, it was only the great Abhinavagupta who perfected it as an integrating theory basic to the aesthetic philosophy of the Indians. Nor was the contribution of those Kashmiri rhetoricians any less important who analysed, interpreted, elaborated and commented upon what the original exponents propounded, thus providing the building blocks on which the Indian aesthetic thought stands today. Profound thinkers like Udbhata, Bhatta Lollata, Shankuka, Bhatta Nayaka, Bhatta Tauta, Rudrata, Ruyyaka, Mahima Bhatta and others. The issues they raised, the solutions they provided, the views they propounded provided grist to the great intellectual debates about the relation of aesthetic object and aesthetic experience which raged throughout India for quite a long time.

To understand the full significance of the art-ideas introduced by the successive Kashmiri thinkers, we shall have to look at them in the overall perspective of the development of Indian aesthetical thought. As we know, it is in the *Natya Shastra*, the legendary Bharata's monumental treatise on dramaturgy, that we find the first systematic exposition of Rasa-a concept central to Indian aesthetic thinking. Supposed to have been written between the 2nd century BC and the 2nd century AD, the *Natya Shastra* provides a deep insight into the psychology of aesthetic experience. It conceives of the drama as the perfect synthesis between all arts and integrates in its form poetic text, histrionics, stage-craft, music, dance, painting and even architecture into an organismic whole, with Rasa as its soul. "There is no art", claims Bharata, "no science, no craft, no skill that does not fall within the purview of drama".

*Na Tajjnana no tat shilpam
N sa vidya na sa kala
Na sau yogo na tat karma
Natye'smin yanna-drishyate*

His well known formulation on *Rasa* in the *Natya Shastra-vibhavnubhava vyabhichari bhava samyogad rasanish-pattih*-explains the aesthetic experience in terms of the prime stimuli or the leading characters in a dramatic presentation, their behavioural features and the transient but ancillary emotional reactions they evoke. Scholars have variously interpreted and translated the Sanskrit terms *vibhava*, *anubhava*, *sanchari bhava* and *rasa* according to their individual perceptions of what these terms mean. Thus, Dr K.C. Pandey translates *vibhava* as the emotive situation, *anubhava* as the physical changes consequent upon the rise of an emotion, *vyabhichari bhava* as transient emotions and *rasa* as the aesthetic object. Raniero Gnoli prefers to use expressions like "Determinants", "Consequents" and "Transitory Mental States" for them, leaving *rasa* untranslated. For the purpose of this paper, however, I have mostly used the equivalents given by Krishna Chaitanya for these key terms for the essential constituents of the aesthetic presentation which enables the aesthetic emotion to be experienced and relished.

We shall have to examine a few more concepts before Bharata's formulation becomes a bit more clear. The *vibhavas* or the primary stimuli arouse the conative dispositional factors abiding in human nature,

which cannot be exactly called instincts but could be described as innate sentiments. In Sanskrit poetics these abiding mental states have been given the name *sthayi bhavas*. It is the *sthayi bhava* or basic sentiment awakened by the union of *vibhavas*, *anubhavas* and the *vyabhichari bhavas* that is finally relished *asrasa*. Put in simpler terms this means that when the prime stimuli or determinants, their consequent behavioural pattern and the transient but ancillary emotional reactions they evoke combine, the basic sentiment is activated and develops into *rasa* or aesthetic emotion.

The *Natya Shastra* distinguishes eight abiding mental states that are latent in a man's psychological organisation. These are

Love (*raiti*),
Laughter (*hasya*)
Sorrow (*shoka*),
Anger (*krodha*),
Heroism (*utsaha*),
Fear (*bhaya*),
Disgust (*jugupsa*),
and Wonder (*vismaya*).

To these a ninth one, Serenity (*shama*) was added later. The corresponding nine *rasas* are:

the Erotic (*shringara*),
the Comic (*hasya*),
the Pathetic (*karuna*),
the Furious (*raudra*),
the Heroic (*vira*),
the Terrible (*bhayanaka*),
the Odious (*bibhatsa*),
and the Marvellous (*adbhuta*).

With this background we can now proceed to understand how ideas which eventually crystallised to form a cogent theory of *rasa* took off from this point of departure. Going back to Bharata's formulation, the *Rasa Sutra*, we find that it contained two crucial words that lent themselves to various interpretations, unleashing storms of controversy. These were *samyoga* and *nishpattih*. There were other questions also that arose from Bharata's condensed but pregnant statement. Where is *Rasa* located? Is the aesthetic experience subjective or objective? How is it related to the other emotions or states of consciousness? Every participant in the great debate that ensued took a stand on these on the basis of his

own philosophical outlook. Among the earliest to address these questions was Bhatta Lollata who lived in Kashmir in the late 8th century or the early 9th. A contemporary of the great Shaivite thinker Bhatta Kallata, Lollata approached those questions as a *Mimamsaka* or grammarian. His works have unfortunately been lost, but from what we learn from the *Abhinava Bharati*, Abhinavagupta's commentary on the *Natya Shastra*, Lollata took only the denotational sense of the word *nishpattih* into consideration and interpreted it as causal origination. *Rasa*, he said, is an effect of which the *vibhavas* or the aesthetic object is the direct cause. It resides in the original historical character (Rama etc.) represented on the stage, as well as the impersonating actor. The actor feels himself as the represented historical personage during the duration of the enactment but remembers his real nature through the faculty of *anusandhana* or recollection (realization, according to Gnoli).

The important question underlying all this discussion is as to how the poetic emotion is transferred from life to art, and Lollata's answer is that the spectator relishes *rasa* or the sentiment located in the character portrayed directly and not through emotional induction by the aesthetic process of activating it. Abhinavagupta quickly rejects this view-point which seeks to turn the sentiment or *sthayi bhava* into an object of perception. Pointing this out, Krishna Chaitanya writes: "Abhinava Gupta's brilliant mind noticed at once that the literalism of the Mimamsakas would annex aesthetics to grammar and bring about as complete an impoverishment in aesthetics as it had brought in philosophy. He saw that Lollata was confusing aesthetic communication with intellectual discourse, the emotive symbol with the denotative sign. Noting that the *sthayi bhava*, which abides as a potential reality and is raised to the relishable state only through the configuration of stimuli etc. (*vibhavadi*), Abhinava argues that it cannot be staticised as an object of perception "existing at only one specific conjunction of space and time." Mammata, an eleventh century Kashmiri aesthete, endorses Abhinava's views by stressing that the object in art is a virtual and not a physical object. It is a virtual object "because the whole phenomenon is processual, the process involving the activity of institution and emotion". Bhatta Lollata's theory, it seems, is totally unconcerned with the spectator's view-point.

Shankuka, another Kashmiri and a younger contemporary of Lollata, approaches the problem of how the spectator relishes *rasa* or the aesthetic experience from the point of view of a logician, *naiyayaka*, which he actually was. *Rasa*, he said, applying syllogistic reasoning, was not produced as an effect as Lollata claimed but could be logically arrived at by the process of inference. Using the analogy of a forest fire he says that just as it can be inferred from the smoke rising from above the top of a cluster of trees, in the same manner the basic mental state can be inferred from the situation presented by the stimuli etc.

Dr K.C. Pandey calls Shankuka's point of view "psycho-epistemic". "In actual life", he points out explaining Shankuka's view-point, "the mental state of a man is revealed by the visible effects of his feeling i.e. the consequents and their concomitant feelings or the transitory mental state. The successful imitation by the actor of the characters and their experiences is no doubt, Shankuka says, artificial and unreal or illusory but is not realised to be so by the spectators who forget the difference between the actors and the characters and inferentially experience the mental state of the characters themselves". Shankuka, in fact, uses the analogy of a painted horse, *chitraturaga*, to bring out the beauty of this imitation (*anukarna*) and holds that aesthetic experience, which is a peculiar form of inference (*anumana*), cannot be classified under any known forms of knowledge.

Shankuka's views, like those of Lollata, have been presented in brief by Abhinavgupta in his famous commentary on *Natya Shastra*, the *Abhinava Bharati*, as Shankuka's works too are lost. The inference and imitation theories of Lollata and Shankuka, which hold the aesthetic presentation to be "the efficient cause (*karaka hetu*) or the logical cause (*jnapak hetu*)" respectively of the aesthetic emotion, were later demolished by Abhinava and the exponents of the *Dhvani* or Suggestion School of poetics. But before we look at what they have to say in the matter, let us try to appreciate the views of Bhatta Nayaka, a great aesthetic thinker who lived in the late 9th century Kashmir and joined the debate to point out the "inwardness of the whole situation". Here again we have to rely upon the *Abhinava Bharati* as Bhatta Nayaka's work the *Hridaya Darpana*, too is not available. He rejects the idea that *rasa* or the aesthetic emotion can be affected or inferred, and tries to extend

the *Sankhya* concept of *bhoga* or enjoyment to the field of aesthetics. *Rasa*, he posits, is neither *atmagata* nor *paragata* nor is it *tatastha vedyā*. That is, it cannot be perceived as located in the spectator or as located in anyone else, whether it be the character portrayed or the actor portraying that character. We can have no perception of *rasa* at all: "*rasah na pratiyate*"!

What Bhatta Nayaka means in other words is that the spectator or the reader does not feel the sorrow or the happiness of the character represented personally as his own because of the aesthetic distance. That is why even a tragic play or a poem does not cause any feeling of pain in him and he is able to "enjoy" or savour its flavour too. Further, he says, ordinary spectator or reader can never identify himself with the extraordinary virtues of such a great hero as Rama. What happens actually is that he enjoys the aesthetic emotion through the *bhojaka-bhojya* relationship. That is, through the relationship of the enjoyer and the enjoyed. Bhatta Nayaka, thus, stresses the importance of *bhavana vyapara* or imagination, which, according to him, comes into play as an aspect of aesthetic experience. Poetic experience, he maintains, has another power besides *abhidha* or the denotational power which enables the *sahridaya* or the aesthetically sensible person to see the characters presented in an aesthetic creation in a generalised way, "independently of any relationship with his ordinary life or the life of the actor or the hero of the play or poem", as Gnoli puts it. This special power Bhatta Nayaka calls *bhavakatva*, the power of generalisation.

The protagonists in their generalised character are perceived to rise above their "specific contextual reference". Thus Rama's love for Sita though particular becomes the universalised experience of love in general. Even pain is transfigured into a sort of pleasure which can be savoured aesthetically. This universalisation of the aesthetic object and subject through the power of *bhavakatva* frees them from all limitations of individuality and is called *sadharanikarana*. The concept of *sadharanikarna* or universality of the aesthetic experience is Bhatta Nayaka's greatest contribution in the field of aesthetic thought.

To explain the relation between the subject and object, Bhatta Nayaka posits another power or function of language - that of *bhojakatva* or enjoyment. It is by the

virtue of this power, according to him, that we relish the experience presented in a poetic creation, not at the practical but at the aesthetic level. All practical considerations fade away due to the predominance of *sattva* or innate goodness of human nature, a state of psychological poise which makes us repose in our own consciousness. The other two potentialities described in the *Sankhya* philosophy, *rajas*, physical dynamism and *tamas*, insensibility, are rendered ineffective. Thus the *bhoga* or enjoyment of *rasa* is a process of delectation very much akin to the state of self-sufficient blissful consciousness which one experiences on realising the Supreme Reality (*Brahman*). Bhatta Nayaka's another important contribution, therefore, is that he brings the aesthetic experience at par with mystic experience. By stressing that it is not determined by practical considerations but is a state of being, he makes it more internal and contemplative, bringing the relisher face to face with the ultimate Universal Reality.

In his comment on Bhatta Nayaka's formulation about universalisation of experience in aesthetics, Abhinavagupta does not seem inclined to dismiss it altogether. In fact, he absorbs his core contentions into his own aesthetic theory and develops them in accordance with his own monistic outlook. He admits that aesthetic enjoyment is similar to the joy that comes from realising one's identity with *Brahman*, but he rejects his three-fold classification of the powers of language on the ground that there is no need "to staticise either the generalising function of poetry as a separate power of *bhava* or the appreciative activity of the reader or spectator as a distinct, isolated power *bhoga*", as this only leads to unnecessary multiplication of concepts.

We shall refer to Abhinavagupta's philosophy of aesthetics later. Suffice it to say here that he accepted Bhatta Nayaka's view that the aesthetic and the mystic experiences spring from the same source and the bliss we derive from them is a state of independence from all extraneous factors--a repose into our own self. But while the state of mystical consciousness is marked by "the complete disappearance of all polarities, the lysis of all dialectics in the dissolving fire of God", to use the words of R.Gnoli "in aesthetic consciousness the feelings and facts of everyday life remain always present", even though they are transfigured. The fact put so succinctly by K.Krishnamurthy, is that so far as

the idea of *rasa* is concerned, Abhinavagupta "takes over where Bhatta Nayaka leaves".

(To be concluded)

(Dr. S.S Toshkhani is a poet, linguist, writer and a thinker. He has contributed substantially to Kashmiri heritage and carried out modern research in various fields of Kashmiri literature, history, religion, art and social sciences.)



MUKTINATH-THE LORD OF LIBERATION

(A TRAVELOGUE)

Dr. G.L. Kaw

Our decision to embark on the Muktinath yatra materialized in very peculiar and rather depressing circumstances. Myself, my daughter (Geetika) and P.P.Dandi Swami Paranand Tirth were at Nepalganj, south western city of Nepal somewhere near the mid-June, 2016. In fact we were waiting since three days for our Kailash Mansarovar visas to arrive when our tour operator from Kathmandu informed us that due to some technical problem our visa could not be arranged and thus the yatra had been cancelled.

Ours was a group of twenty people, of which thirteen of us had travelled from Delhi to Nepalganj via Lucknow by road, and others were waiting at Katmandu itself. All of us packed our bags to leave for Lucknow at the earliest. We were angry and agitated, but there was no body to argue with within sight. When we were waiting for our vehicles to take us back to Lucknow in the lobby of the hotel, Swamiji suggested that we could go to Muktinath yatra instead of returning back with the group. Since we had no clue about the place, we started surfing the net and found that Muktinath was about 400 kms from Kathmandu on the northern part of Nepal-Tibet border. We contacted Delhi and Kathmandu and conveyed Swamiji's suggestion. And to our surprise, we got a call from our tour operator saying that it was possible

to start the yatra from the next day provided we could reach Kathmandu that day itself.

It was already half past three in the afternoon and we asked him to arrange the air tickets for three of us as soon as possible. Meanwhile the vehicles reached the hotel premises and our group rushed to board along with their heavy baggages and hearts. They were shouting towards us to be quick so we could leave at the earliest. We were in an enigmatic situation, but after Swamiji's signal we requested them to leave without us. Around 4.15pm we got the message that our tickets have been booked for the last flight of Buddha Air from Nepalganj, which would leave at 5pm. We requested hotel staff to arrange a taxi to take us to airport as soon as possible. Within minutes we got copies of the tickets in our mail and we were now eager to leave for airport, before it was too late. Ultimately the taxi arrived and we were on the road to airport at 4.35pm. We asked the driver to drive faster to reach in time but he didn't seem to listen to anything. As soon as we left the hotel area, we saw that the road was almost non-existent, it being, a dirt track with numerous pot-holes and bumps.

We reached airport at about five and somebody was waiting there for us who managed check-in formalities within no time and just after few minutes we were sitting in the waiting lounge. Here, to our relief, we came to know that flight would take off at 5.25pm. Sitting in the waiting hall we could see the whole airport in one glance including the recently landed Buddha Airlines and its passenger baggage which was being towed on hand driven carts. Ultimately, our flight took off at 5.30pm, and we landed at Kathmandu at 6.30pm. It was a reasonably comfortable flight though it was a small eighty seater plane and we were seated in the last row. Domestic airport at Kathmandu also wasn't much different than that of Nepalgang. Here one Mr. Tej, from travel agency was waiting for us and we reached our hotel around 7.30pm.

The hotel, Shangrila in Kathmandu is a five star hotel with old world architecture and charm. Its wooden furniture and floorings with a majestic staircase make an impressive scene. We settled in our rooms and had our dinner in the dinning hall, where Mr. Tej informed us that we would be leaving for Pokhara the next morning around 9am.

Next day, we were ready at 9 am, when our travel agent reached with the vehicle and we left the hotel

around 9.30am. The initial twenty or so kms of the road were bumpy and potholed with heavy traffic and dusty atmosphere. But afterwards the road was reasonably good though narrow. We stopped somewhere for breakfast and tea etc and after driving for three hours on a beautiful winding road along the bank of Trisuli River and amidst the lush green pine forests we reached a town called Muglik. Here we diverted from the main road for the famous Manakaamna Temple.



This temple is atop a high mountain ridge at about one day's trekking distance from the village below. But there is a cable car facility available now from cable station of Cheres. The station is situated at a picturesque foothill, surrounded by well-kept lawns and gardens. Cable cars looked quite sturdy and the cable very long and fiercely steep. There was a long queue at the ticket window and in the waiting hall also. Eventually we boarded the car along with three more passengers, and after what seemed to be a long time (12 minutes) we reached the mountain ridge. Afterwards we came to know that the cable is about two kms long, and has been imported from Austria and has strict maintenance procedures in place. After walking down for about half a km we reached the long queue for Darshan. On the way there were plenty of shops selling Prasad and pooja material along with handicrafts, souvenirs and other artifacts. We also

purchased some pooja material and joined the long queue. The Manakaamna Temple is supposed to be a 17th century structure of four stories overlooking the river valleys of Trishuli and Marsyangdi. People believe that Mother Goddess fulfills all the wishes of her devotees. There are many legends about the temple. But, after reaching the temple arena, there was a sad disappointment in store for us. The temple had been badly damaged in the recent earthquake. It has been completely razed now and the new construction has just begun. The deities have been shifted to a makeshift shack, where devotees perform the pooja etc. We also performed the pooja and hurried back to Muglik town for lunch. From here a drive of three hours took us to the beautiful city of Pokhara.

Pokhara is the second largest city of Nepal after Kathmandu. We were pleased to see the vibrant city with its hundreds of hotels, lodges and restaurants and beautiful and bountiful markets. Even the city roads were wide and clean. Pokhara is the part of the Kaski district of Nepal and is easily the most famous and favorite tourist destination of the country. The famous mountain ranges of Annapurna (Part of Himalayas) with its high peaks of Dhaulagiri and Manaslu bestow a rare picturesque sight to the city. The main river flowing through the city is Seti-gandaki, which has created several gorges and canyons. But what seemed to be the greatest epitome of the beauty of the city is large lake, about 5kms in length, on the eastern bank of which most of the city is located. The lake is called Phewa lake by the locals. We checked-in the Land-Mark hotel, a 3-star hotel on the lakeside with excellent facilities and services. It was drizzling outside.



At dinner time, our guide informed us that it would not be possible for us to fly to Jomsom the next morning due to the bad weather and for last two days no flights have taken off. He further added that there is

already a long waiting list for air tickets and he could only try for day after tomorrow. Next morning the sky was heavily overcast, though it was not raining. The mountains and lush green forests were partially covered with low hanging clouds which made a very pleasant sight. Mr. Tej reached around 9am and told us that he has arranged a Toyota Tempo for your sight seeing as our vehicle is not permitted for the same here. These brand new well equipped vehicles are used especially for tourists.

We first went to Tal Barahi Temple, as it quite close to our hotel. This temple is situated on a small island in the midst of the Phewa lake. We had to hire a boat to reach the island. We were asked to wear life jackets provided by the management there. It took about ten minutes to reach the island. Landing at the small but beautiful island I could not but feel nostalgic about Char-Chinari Island in the world-famous Dal-lake of Kashmir.



The temple here is a small two storey pagoda style structure in the centre of the island. We purchased some Prasad and pooja material and performed pooja. Swamiji was very pleased to see the temple and recited the mantras while worshipping the deity. Barahi-Mata is a form of Durga, and locals have an interesting legend about the temple. It goes as, once mother Goddess came in the garb of a beggar and beseeched every body for alms. But no one except a simple householder offered her everything. Goddess in her anger made the whole village get immersed in the water, except the small house of noble house owner. And it is at the site of the same house the temple of today stands and got named as BARAHI—meaning getting filled with water.



From there we went to Bindya Basini Temple. It was just a few kms away located on a hilltop. We had to park our vehicle on the roadside and climb a few flights of stairs to reach the temple arena. It was again an ancient, small pagoda style temple with a radiant deity inside. When we reached the gate of the temple, a bride and bridegroom were performing some rites and photography etc. Since the sanctum sanctorum of the temple is quite small we had to wait for some time to perform our Pooja. There is a female pujari conducting the pooja rites. In the temple premises there was a Shiva temple also, visibly a recent construction. We went to have the darshana of Shiv-linga, when a motley crowd of student pujaris came rushing and started reciting Rudra-Abhisheka mantras in very loud and clear voice as if competing with each other. Swamiji had to calm them down at intervals. Overall it was a pleasant experience.



Now, our guide told us that we shall go to visit a famous gorge of Pokhara. Swamiji was feeling tired and decided to retire back to hotel room, but asked us to go around to a few more places. Thus we went to hotel and asked the driver to wait for us till we return. When we were leaving the hotel, we saw a group of Gujarati speaking people in the hotel lobby talking about Muktinath Yatra. Out of sheer curiosity, we interacted with them and came to know that they belonged to an NRI group from England, and were waiting for the Jomsom flights since two days. They were happy to know that we were also planning for the

same yatra and prayed sincerely that we could make it together. At this happy note we left the hotel to board our vehicle and drove a few kms and reached a park like site. We had to buy the tickets to enter the place. Inside we were taken by the guide to abridge like structure from where one could see the great Gorge- a very deep fissure between two gigantic rocks, through which a seemingly small river was flowing with a fierce speed and sound- a geological wonder! We tried to take a few photographs of the place and left for another almost similar but more wonderful place called Sita-Pani- a white water river gushing out of a huge fissure in a rock with very loud sound.

It had started raining and atmosphere was quite pleasant. We decided to visit Gupteshwar Mahadev . Our vehicle took us to the city centre .Our guide led us to a busy commercial area and from a distance we could see the large gate of Gupteshwar temple. As soon as we entered the gate a beautiful spiral staircase of heavy concrete led us to the entrance of a huge natural underground cave, which was dimly lit. Once inside a flight of stone stairs led to the deeper parts of the cave. Water was dripping from every side of the cave, and after descending five flights of slippery stairs, we reached a square, where a very ancient (Probably 5000 yrs old) swayambhu Shiv-ling was standing in the centre. Shiv-linga has been eroded and corroded due to the dripping water, but is still more than five feet tall. It is an awe inspiring site. We performed pooja for some time and took some photographs and were feeling simply blessed to see such a natural wonder. From here, our guide led us deeper down in the cave through few more rough stairs and corridors which were at places hardly four feet tall and we had to bend double to negotiate the way to reach a deeper enclave, where a gigantic sound was heard from a distance. The area had no lighting, except a large crevice on one side of the roof to usher in natural light, sufficient only to see our path. Proceeding ahead, we saw a large river gushing forth from under a huge rock and roaring towards the opposite side from where its further course could not be made out due to darkness and depth. We tried to take a few photographs but due to lack of light it was not possible. Due to the dripping and seeping water in the cave we were almost wet when we reached the exit gate, to find that it was raining heavily outside. Since we were in some marketplace, we rushed to some shops and spent some time shopping for small knickknacks. Our guide told us that there are a few

more places of interest in the city and asked about our choice. But we were feeling more than satisfied with what we had seen and decided to return to hotel instead.



After a few hours our travel agent informed us that that the flights to Jomsom town were not possible even for the next day so we might have to go by road. He added that the final programme shall be discussed after dinner only. Since the rains had stopped and weather was very pleasant, myself and Geetika decided to have a stroll in the market place. It was a modern market with well decorated and well stuffed shops, many eating places and trekking equipment shops. Market was full of all sorts of western and Japanese tourists. Within an hour or so we returned to the hotel. At the dinner time, NRI Gujaratis were not seen, but we met a smaller group of south Indian tourists who also planned to leave for Muktinath Yatra the next day. They had reached Pokhara a few hours back only and were actually the part of our original group of Kailash Yatra and had been waiting in Kathmandu for last six days.

After dinner, Mr. Tej our travel agent informed us that we should be leaving early in the morning by four wheel drive jeeps. He said ours is a group of twenty or so people and four sturdy vehicles have been arranged for the travel. He informed us that here onwards our guide will be one Mr. Karma who is an expert in trekking expeditions. We were asked to leave the heavier bags there in the hotel and carry a small bag with essentials for one night only. We returned to our rooms and informed Swamiji about the programme.

Next day all of us were ready by 7.30am. Our breakfast packages were loaded in the vehicles and we left to reach another hotel named –Waterfront Hotel- a newly constructed hotel on the bank of Phewa Taal.

Here we met NRI Gujaratis, who were ready with their bags etc. Now we were a group of 25 people including two guides and drivers. By 8.30am all the four vehicles left for the long journey. After about two and a half hours of driving we stopped somewhere near a roadside eating place. We opened our breakfast packs and ordered some tea and milk. Till now it was a reasonably good road with light traffic. Soon we restarted our journey and in no time we noticed that the road slowly vanished and it took the shape of a mountainous stony pathway winding along a river bank. The river was flowing at a furious speed with muddy waters. We were told that this is Kaali-Gandaki River and it shall accompany us right up to Muktinath. Sky was overcast all along and a few spells of light rain also greeted us on the way. After a grueling and strenuous drive for about three or so hours we stopped for lunch at a roadside small but clean restaurant. Soon we were again on the road. The road, if it could be called so, was awful, full of heavy stone boulders, numerous turns and twists, but the picturesque scenery of lush green pine forests on the both sides, fast and furious river and cool climate were a treat to eyes and mind both. We also saw some small patches of apple and apricot orchards near the banks of the river. Small and bushy willow trees were also seen sporadically. Due to horrible road conditions our vehicles could not drive for more than ten to twelve kms per hour. Ultimately, we reached the beautiful small town of Jomsom at around 7pm. We lodged at one Himalyan Inn lodge. It was small but clean two storey structure with an energetic landlady. After settling in our rooms, myself and Geetika went out to have a look of the town. The whole town is located on the bank of Kaali-Gadaki river and bisected by the main road. There is a small airport also, with the gate opening on the main road. It is the highest airport and helipad of Nepal and is under army control. There are many small hotels, eating places and Buddhist Pagodas on both sides of the road.

After dinner, our guides asked us to be ready at 5am in the morning, as we should leave for the penultimate yatra very early so that we return before noon and then proceed for Pokhara without any delay. Next day, our guide knocked our doors at 4.30am only, and we were all ready by 5am. We boarded our vehicles and drove upto the end of the town (hardly 1km), when we were asked to get down and cross the small wooden bridge on foot. This bridge separated the town from Muktinath road, wherefrom we were supposed to hire

Land cruiser jeeps for the onward journey. Soon we were going uphill the Thorong La Mountain by an acutely winding road which was not as bad as we had travelled the day before. The only difficulty was that the road was very steep all along. On the way we saw



a few villages which were nothing but a cluster of ten to fifteen houses shrouded in groves of willow, apricot and other bushy trees. Rest of the mountain side was absolutely dry, and its higher reaches and peaks were of a variety of colors. Deep down at the base of the mountain, Kaali-Gandaki river with its wide and stony span made a lovely sight. After about two hours of driving (around 25kms), we reached a bigger village named Ranipauwa. It had few lodges, restaurants and some government offices. Our vehicles were parked on the outskirts of this village and from here we had to trek up to the temple.



Some of our co-yatris hired the horses, but we decided to walk the distance. It was hardly 2.5kms, and not very steep. Towards the end there were few dozen stairs to the temple complex. Once we entered the arena, we felt invigorated but calm and peaceful. Gone were all the travails of the journey. We took rest for a while to absorb the natural and supernatural aura of the place.

The temple of Muktinath—the lord of liberation, salvation or Nirvana is sacred for both Hindus and Buddhists. It is located in the Mustang district of Nepal, at the height of 3700 mts in the foot of Thorong La mountain pass. The whole shrine is enclosed in a large grove of trees. South Indian Vaishnavites call this place Muktidham. They believe that people from south have been coming here for Darshana since centuries. In some sacred texts the place is called Thiru-Saligrammam. Saligram is a shila (stone), found in its natural form in Gandaki River and Damodar Kund, which is one of the sources of the river. Saligram is considered as the naturally available form of Shriman Narayan. This is supposed to be the most ancient Vishnu temple, though the present temple has been built in 1815AD. It is a small temple built in pagoda style with a smaller santum-santorum(Garba-Greh), which has three radiant metallic deities of Vishnu, Laxmi and Garuda. The murtis are gold plated or made of gold, about five feet tall.



The outer courtyard or Pradikshana has many pranalis pouring clean ice cold water. Around the temple on three sides 108 pipes are seen spouring water from a height of about seven feet to make the sight of a unique shower. In front of the temple there are two ponds or Kunds of water named as Laxmi and Saraswati kundas. Tibetan Buddhists call the place as Chuming Gyatsa, and the deity in the gompa as Avalokiteshwara. They believe that Guru Rinpoche (Padmasambhava- the founder of Tibetan Buddhism) had meditated there on his way to Tibet. This place is supposed to be a Shakti-Peeth also and it is believed that the forehead of the Sati fell here. As Shakti-Peeth it is known as Gandaki-Chandi.

We decided to take bath one by one. One had to make a complete circumambulation of the temple, while taking a quick shower under all the 108 pipes and finally a dip in the two ponds. Water was ice-cold, but

after the bath we felt relaxed and re-energized. We purchased some pooja material from the nearby hawker and went inside to perform the pooja. There was a male pujari, who was chanting the mantras continuously. The Darshana of the deities was simply divine and rather inexplicable. Then we had a Parikrama of the temple after which Swamiji sat on the right side of the gate of the temple and performed pooja with his Saligrama. We were also the silent participants of the pooja and felt truly blessed to be witnessing it. Our South Indian friends performed an elaborate pooja on the right hand side of the temple. They had brought a large bag of pooja material with them. Meanwhile our guide was coercing us to make hurry for return journey. On our way back we visited a small Jawala Mai temple of Buddhists, where a small flame is believed to be burning eternally on water, soil and rock. I saw one only on the surface of water which was covered by an iron net.



After coming down the trekking path, we boarded our Jeeps and within an hour and a half we were at the hotel. We collected our bags, had a quick lunch and left for Pokhara around 11.30am. We travelled the same treacherous road nonstop up to 5.30pm, when we stopped for a cup of tea somewhere near Beni. From here the road was better, though it was raining most of the time. At just past 7pm we reached Pokhara and all of us checked in the Water-front hotel.

Since we had a tiring journey for two days we decided to take rest for one more day at Pokhara. The driver, who had come with us from Kathmandu was in the city. We called him the next day and went for a tour of local market. It was a pleasant experience to buy few local things there. In the afternoon we roamed around in the premises of the hotel, which was very neat and clean, and the lawns and pathways beautifully decorated and manicured. The hotel being very near the lake we went to the bank of the lake, where one

could enjoy a magnificent view of the lake and surrounding lush green mountains. People were fishing, playing or just lazing around. We had a view of the paragliders also, who would land at the adjacent ground.

Next day, we started early in the morning for Kathmandu. It was already drizzling, and along the way also it rained sporadically, making the surrounding scenery very pleasing to eye. Soon Swamiji informed us that It is Poornamashi and he should have a shave and mundan before he performs the pooja. We asked our driver if it was possible to find a barber in some wayside town. He stopped in the town of Muglik in the market place and me and the driver walked around to search for the barber. Fortunately, we found a young Hindi speaking barber who accepted to take us to nearby river bank for mundan and bathing purposes. Our driver went for his lunch and we accompanied the barber to the river bank. Just short of the river bank, there was a small water fall through a bull-face, especially made for bathing purposes. Just on the side of the waterfall was a station like concrete structure where we set up a temporary barber shop. After the shave and Mundan, Swamiji had a bath and we returned to main market, where our driver was waiting for us. After having

lunch somewhere just outside the town we drove non-stop up to Katmandu. But the last twenty or so kms of the road was almost clogged with heavy traffic, and it took us more than two hours to reach the city. Finally around 7pm we were in the Hotel Shangrila.

The journey was more or less comfortable and enjoyable also. The roads were relatively good, scenery picturesque and weather cool calm and clean. Most of the times our road was winding along the banks of Trishuli or Phesing River flowing in opposite directions. Next day, we visited a few important places in the city of Katmandu and flew back to Delhi after two days.

(Dr G.L Kaw is a medical practitioner based in Gandhinagar Gujarat with an avid interest in history, philosophy, classical Sanskrit and Persian literature)





SELECTED POEMS

Rashneek Kher

He and Me

*The light of the candle and maybe the wick arose,
Deep down oceans did the vermilion froze
Sleep of the ages and the slumber of the night
Did the ice break or the seas cease to be;*

*Isn't it the light that's not to be
Did I wake up the light of thee
Did my eyes see what they had to see
Am I blind, wondering who is He;*

*I begin to rain and I am me
I think of thee and I am thee*

*Who then is thy if not me!
Did I see thy or was it me..*

Was the light him or was it me..

Did we coalesce that's Him and me

Void

My anatomy revealed a hole

A void that my death left

She was alone...

It was a forlorn path

From one exile to another

Void as is..but a void

Fill it...my land

With the cherries of spring

And almond flowers

A folklore from past

To carry me through

The forlorn path

Yasin's mother

Or maybe Rasul Daar

Know stories of past

*Whilst the hole was
Still my youth*

*The youth I lost
In sands of time
And the hole,
my friend remained on
In me
Jill
Death did us apart*

*I
The waves washed the shore
And my house too...
But the sand remained
And so did I*

(Rashneek Kher is a Kashmiri poet and a literary critic living in exile in Faridabad)



BOOK RREVIEW: THE PRATYABHIJNA PHILOSOPHY BY DR G V TAGARE

By Dr Advaitavadini Kaul

*yovikalpamidamarthamandalam
pashyatisha nikhilam bhavadvapuh
svatmapakshaparipurite jagat
yasya nitya sukhinah kuto bhayam
(Shivastotravali XIII.16)*

"O Lord one who sees (recognizes) this entire objective world as non-relational pure consciousness. Thus, identifying individual consciousness with Universal Consciousness and (hence) attaining Divine Bliss, from where or from whom should one get scared?"

The unique message of Kashmir Saiva philosophy is to have a positive approach towards each and every aspect of this world. This philosophy is meant for all human beings irrespective of caste, creed, colour or sex. Since it aims at enabling an individual to rise from individuality to universality, it is a practical philosophy that helps a human being to know his inner being i.e. the Self.

Kashmir Saiva philosophy popularly known as *Trika* philosophy comprises four methods/theories known as *Pratyabhijna* i.e. realizing individual self as Universal Self; *Kula* i.e. realizing the totality of universe; *Krama* i.e. the successive realization of an individual and *Spanda* i.e. recognizing that all existence depends on Vibration. All these methods/theories have been developed on the basis of the same Saiva scriptures known as *Agamas*. Basically their goal is the same i.e. to help individuals to rise on the spiritual path. Various methods and theories got developed keeping in view

individual capacities with varied degrees of capabilities.

Pratyabhijna seems to have enjoyed maximum recognition even outside Kashmir. Reference may be made of the *Sarvadarshansamgraha* in which Madhavacharya the great Vedantin scholar (14th century AD) has reviewed Kashmir Saiva philosophy basing it on *Pratyabhijnas darsana*.

The *Pratyabhijna Philosophy* written by a senior scholar and Mahapandit from Maharashtra Dr. Ganesh Vasudeva Tagare has its title adopted from the above mentioned Madhavacharya's review of Kashmir Saiva philosophy as expressed by the author himself. Dr. Tagare has already written two books on Kashmir Saivism titled *Vasugupta's Spanda Karika* and *Saiva Philosophy*. This is his third book on the subject which is a welcome addition to the compendiums on Kashmir Saiva philosophy in general. It is specially a hand book on the *Pratyabhijna* philosophy in which the learned author has tried to accommodate all information on *Pratyabhijna* at one place. The introduction to the book prepares the ground by giving a brief account of the prevalence of Saiva faith in Kashmir along with other faiths particularly Buddhism. The main body of the book is divided into five chapters followed by an epilogue.

The first chapter starts with historical developments under which the *Pratyabhijna* theory evolved through the teachings of various preceptors. Hence the chapter has been appropriately titled as the 'Teachers of the *Pratyabhijna Doctrine*'. While drawing a line of the teachers the author has ably made use of genealogical tables and has presented the view point of each teacher on the *Pratyabhijna*. It was Somananda, the disciple of Vasugupta who formulated the *Pratyabhijna* theory by studying deeply the *Saiva Agamas*. Following Sommananda, Utpalacharya, Abhinvagupta and Kshemaraja formed a line of teachers who developed the doctrine and its practices systematically. Here, Dr. Tagare also takes into account the great Madhavacharya's review on Kashmir Saiva philosophy (*Pratyabhijna*).

In the second chapter, the concept of *Pratyabhijna* has been placed in the frame of the fundamental concepts of Kashmir Saiva thought and a broader background of the main thought currents also has been presented

which already prevailed in India. The author has discussed the fundamental concepts while giving technical explanation (very important for clear understanding) of each concept under ten headings as under: 1. *Pati: Para-Siva* (Ultimate Principle) 2. *Pasu: Jivatman* (individual consciousness/self/soul) 3. *Visva*: (The universe and its 36 components) 4. *Pasa: Mala; Bandha* (bondage) 5. *Upaya* (means of removing *pasa*) 6. *Diksa*: (initiation) or *Saktipata* (grace) 7. *Moksa*: (liberation from Samsara) 8. *Savatantravada* (doctrine of Free Will) 9. *Abhasavada*: (all inclusive Universal Consciousness) 10. *Shadadhva*: (six fold way). The chapter gives preliminary understanding of the philosophy which is a pre-requisite for the next chapter (ch. 3) dealing with the literature on the *Pratyabhijna*.

The *Isvara Pratyabhijna Vimarsini* is a commentary written by Abhinavagupta on *Isvara Pratyabhijna* of Utpalacharya. According to Utpala *Pratyabhijna* is an easy and novel way to *moksa* (merging in the Universal Consciousness): *sugata esa margo navo* (IP IV.I.16). This way to *moksa* is believed to have been first noticed by Somananda who advocated a psychological cum spiritual method of attaining the state of Supreme Consciousness while keeping in view the difficulties of a common man in adopting the three *upayas* already prescribed by Vasugupta in his *Siva Sutras*. Utpala formulated this theory by composing his *Isvara Pratyabhijna*. It was Abhinavagupta who created a majestic structure of *Pratyabhijna* through his commentary on Utpala's text. The chapter presents a summary of Abhinavagupta's commentary while incorporating all points from the commentator's text. A Roman transliteration of Utpala's original Sanskrit text along with English translation also of the commentary are given. Use has been made of important subheadings to make the reading understandable even for a lay reader.

The *Pratyabhijna-hrdaya* (Essence of *Pratyabhijna*) forms the subject matter of fourth chapter of the book. This treatise is a digest of *Pratyabhijna* compiled by the versatile aims at elucidating the main tenets of the *Pratyabhijna* lucidly and succinctly. He states at the very outset of his work "The truth of the teaching of *Pratyabhijna* is

explained briefly for those devoted people who aspire after *Samavesa* (getting merged in the Lord), but who have not studied different works on Logic and Dialectics and hence have not developed intellectual capacity to understand or grasp the *Pratyabhijna*". It presents a systematic exposition of *citi* (the power of the Absolute) in twenty sutras (aphorisms). The topic of each sutra has been listed in this chapter followed by translations of the *sutras*. The transliterated original *sutras* and Kshemaraja's explanation is given by Dr. Tagare. Other interpretations also have been incorporated wherever found necessary.

Chapter five contains a free translation of Madhavacharya's review (of Kashmir Saivism) of which reference has already been made more than once. In his review the Vedantin Scholar has adopted a considerable number of passages from the *Isvara Pratyabhijna* and its commentary *vimarsini*.

The Epilogue explains very briefly the relevance of *Pratyabhijna* in 21st century which the author rightly says "is a soothing factor if not a panacea to the suffering humanity". Here a brief survey of the *Pratyabhijna* is given in the beginning of the Epilogue. By appending a glossary of technical terms the author has really done a yeoman's job for it is next to impossible to understand any text in the absence of proper explanation the technical terms, which usually give varied meanings in different contexts. Inclusion of notes, bibliography and an index have made the work more comprehensive. All over get up and printing of the book is also satisfactory. This is a useful book for specialists who can use as a reference book on the *Pratyabhijna* as also for lay readers who can use it to elevate their self.

Book Details: *The Pratyabhijna Philosophy* by Dr. G.V. Tagare, pp xiii plus 165, Motilal Banarsidas Publishers Pvt. Ltd., Delhi, 2002, Rs. 295/-

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(First Published at <http://ignca.nic.in/nl002609.htm>)



YOGTANTRAGAMA
ISSN NO: 2454-888X



Published by : Rashneek Kher, 901-902, Iris Tower, Faridabad, Haryana, 121010 for YTA Inc.

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Logo: Manik Chawla

